

- iii) enforcement of laws like the Untouchability Act; and
- iv) difficulties of these sections of society – ill-treatment, practice of untouchability, discrimination and lack of access to financial and technical assistance to entrepreneurs belonging to these classes.

The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, the National Commission of Backward Classes (NCBC), the State Backward Class Commissions, the Minorities Commission, the National Commission on Women and the State Commissions on Women also conduct surveys, bring together and review a large amount of data on the progress of or the lack of progress in curbing exploitation of, and violence against these sections of society, raising the shares in education and employment of these communities and groups and in empowering and bringing these sections into the mainstream of life. These are comprehensive sources of data on the efforts being made and need to be made to empower these sections of society and elevate their status in society. The Commission for the Aged (Senior Citizens) and the Commission for Children are sources of data on these sections gathered at one place from various primary sources⁵¹ and analysed to highlight issues that need attention. The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (Annual Report of the Ministry), the nodal agency that is entrusted with the responsibility for the development and empowerment of the physically and mentally challenged, the weaker sections of society and women and the development of children and the welfare of the aged, constitute another source of data on the status of these vulnerable groups in society.

Check Your Progress 4

- 1) What kind of data/information is provided by NSSO on housing conditions in India?
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- 2) Do you think that the data on registrants with the employment exchanges provide adequate information about the persons displayed by development projects? Give reasons in support of your answer.
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⁵¹ For instance, for the aged, important sources of data are (a) the NSSO Report No. 446 (52nd Round) "The Aged in India – A Socio-economic Profile: 1995-96". The Census 2001 is a mine of information on the Aged as it presents a number of social, economic and cultural characteristics by age groups and gender, one such group being 60+. Data on women and children and the disabled also flow from the Census and other sources of data for these groups have already been referred to elsewhere in this unit.

- 3) Name the documents, which contain the statistics on environment.

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- 4) Which department/ministry has been assigned the responsibility to provide information data on development and empowerment of weaker sections of the society?

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24.9 LET US SUM UP

We have tried to enumerate the various sources of data in the social sector and looked at the kind of data available in different sub-sectors of the social sector. We have seen that there are a number of sources of data on employment covering parts of the economy. There are two sources that are comprehensive and cover the entire economy. These enable an analysis of trends in employment and unemployment over the years, the industrial, occupational and educational composition of the employed and their age profile, the educational profile and the age structure of the unemployed, the quality and adequacy of employment in terms of wages, tenure of employment and employment security of workers. Similar analysis is possible for several subsections of the economy and society that are relevant to the country's objectives of economic and social policies. The database on welfare of labour is somewhat incomplete in some areas, calling for stricter monitoring of the submission of statutory returns and the implementation of existing legislation. Enormous amount of data on educational infrastructure, the utilization of such facilities and the output of the educational system are available and periodic comprehensive surveys add to the richness of the database. However, there is a need to go into such discrepancies as may be there between data collected by the reporting system in the educational administration and the data thrown up by the surveys, to initiate corrective action to tone up the large database built up over the years. Another important need is to reduce the time lag in the availability of data for policy makers as well as researchers. Data on health are being built up from more than one source, namely, the Registrar General of India on aspects like vital rates such as birth and death rates, IMR, MMR and morbidity rates and life expectancy, while the CBHI collects and brings together data from the different wings of the Ministry of Health and the State Health Departments and the different health professional councils. Health and Medicare and health situation data are comprehensive in terms of item coverage but time lags need to be reduced so that data relating a particular time point is complete in terms of coverage of all States and Union Territories. Data from NFHS is a valuable

addition to the database on health, especially from the point of view of health and nutrition status of women and children. The database on shelter and amenities has been updated recently by the Census 2011 and the NSSO survey of the 69th round (July – December, 2012) and also includes specific data on urban slums. A database on environment – air pollution, soil degradation and noise pollution – is getting built up steadily. Data on levels of living, both in terms of income and non-income aspects of life and for the general population as well as for the weaker sections of society can be derived from existing data and used as a basis for planning programmes to reduce poverty and inequalities.

We have also noted a grey area in the data systems we have considered. There is no data worth the name on people displaced from their livelihoods by development projects and the number among these who have been resettled in alternative livelihood. There is a growing realization, at least among some sections of development analysts and thinkers that the burden of the costs of development is invariably borne mostly by the poor and the voiceless. There is an urgent need to build up a transparent database on people displaced by development projects and their resettlement and the basic amenities made available to them.

24.10 SOME USEFUL BOOKS

Ministry of Environment and Forest (2009)	: State of Environment Report, India
Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (2013)	: Green National Accounts in India – A Framework
Ministry of Labour and Employment (2010)	: Indian Labour Yearbook 2009 and 2010

24.11 ANSWERS OR HINTS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress 1

- 1)
 - i) Employment Market Information (EMI) Programme of Directorate General of Employment and Training (DGE&T), Ministry of Labour
 - ii) State Directorates of Employments (DES)
 - iii) Economic Census
 - iv) Annual Survey of Industries
 - v) Population Census
 - vi) Quinquennial Sample Surveys on employment and unemployment conducted by NSSO.
- 2) See Sub-section 24.2.1
- 3) Usual Principal Status (UPS), Usual Principal and Subsidiary Status (UPSS), Current Weekly Status (CWS) and the Current Daily Status (CDS).
- 4) See Sub-section 24.2.3

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) The department of School Education and higher education of Ministry of Human Resource Development, NCAER, UGC, Institute of Applied Manpower Research etc.
- 2) See footnote no. 29
- 3) Do yourself

Check Your Progress 3

- 1) See Section 24.4
- 2) State Level estimates of demographic and health parameters and the data on various socio-economic factors crucial for bringing changes in demographic and health situations.
- 3) Composite measure that takes into account both chronic and acute malnutrition.

Check Your Progress 4

- 1) See Section 24.5
- 2) See Section 24.6
- 3) The annual Reports of Ministry of Environment and Forest and the compendium of environment statistics.
- 4) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (annual reports of the Ministry).